

device you are using, or what's in your browser history, everyone sees the exact same information on Wikipedia.

No single entity or establishment (including the Wikimedia Foundation) controls the content published on Wikipedia; It is instead curated by a global community of volunteers who have created various policies and guidelines to determine what content is published on Wikipedia. Volunteers publicly add, edit and debate about content on Wikipedia to ensure it is fact-based, well-sourced and presented fairly, proportionately, and as far as possible, without editorial bias. Lastly, Wikipedia is not divided in terms of countries (i.e. there is not an "Indian Wikipedia"), but instead there are different language editions of Wikipedia.

❏ How is Wikimedia addressing the digital divide in India, specifically reaching users in non-metro areas and those with limited internet access?

A The Foundation is committed to addressing knowledge gaps related to smaller language Wikipedias and increasing digital literacy among Wikipedia enthusiasts in Tier 2/3 cities. For example, we support the work of our partners such as the Centre for Internet and Society - Access to Knowledge (CIS-A2K) who work on the ground to provide training and programs for youth in rural areas to enhance their digital skills and contributions to Wikimedia projects.

Furthermore, for users that may have unreliable internet connections, Wikipedia apps are also a great source for gaining knowledge. Wikipedia articles can be saved to reading lists and made available offline on the Wikipedia app, which is a really popular feature on Android phones. To further make Wikipedia accessible more widely across India, the Wikipedia app is also available on the Jio app store for mobile, PC and the JioBook.

❏ How are you leveraging Indian academia and local government to deliver on Wikimedia's knowledge mission in India?



WIKIPEDIA

The Free Encyclopedia

A The Wikimedia Foundation welcomes collaborations and initiatives with local partners and institutes that can help advance our mission of ensuring that everyone is able to access and share knowledge on Wikipedia and other Wikimedia projects.

One such long-term collaboration is with IIIT Hyderabad, who has been our key partner in hosting events and conferences for Wikimedia community volunteers and other mission-aligned stakeholders. For example, the bi-annual Wikimedia Technology Summit is dedicated to bringing together technologists, researchers and community members to discuss and find solutions for integrating marginalised languages and communities into the Wikimedia projects.

We have also established WikiClubs in various technology institutions across the country. Through this initiative, we hope to organise outreach activities particularly in colleges located in Tier 2/3 cities to raise awareness amongst students about benefits of developing open-source technology and contributing to local language Wikimedia projects.

Also, to support our translation services for Indian languages, we have integrated the IndicTrans2 model developed by AI4Bharat@IIT Madras, into our global Machine in Translation (MinT) translation services. Supported by the Digital India Bhashini Mission, this project covers all 22 scheduled languages of India. This will help increase contributions in Indian languages on Wikipedia, and help improve the quality of machine translations available in

these local languages. Furthermore, the Foundation has supported CIS-A2K and the Telugu Wikimedia community in collaborating with the Department of Language and Culture, Telangana, to digitise cultural heritage resources and make them available on the Wikimedia projects so that they can be accessed by even more people.

❏ How does Wikipedia aim to meet the evolving needs of Indian users?

A Media reports in India indicate a significant rise in the use of the internet in local languages. According to surveys conducted by the Wikimedia Foundation among Indian users, having information in local languages is among the top 5 motivations for using and trusting online information. Wikipedia's availability in local language is among the top 10 attributes associated with the Wikipedia brand.

We are committed towards strengthening our technological capabilities to support language translations and knowledge access in local languages. This can help make sure more people can participate in knowledge creation and sharing in India. The Foundation's MinT translation service specifically focuses on simplifying the process of translating Wikipedia content and expanding access to accurate information in underrepresented languages.

Furthermore, Indians are browsing, and downloading apps more than ever. We see a great potential for growth in the use of the Wikipedia app on mobile devices in the country, especially for users who are looking to access trustworthy information on apps without any worries of ads, algorithms that influence content, or privacy threats. Year-on-year, we see the highest installs of the Wikipedia app from India.

India remains a top country in terms of making edits on Wikipedia through the Android app. Additionally, we've learned that users in the Indian market appreciate articles with local context, and enjoy features such as Places that allows them to find articles based on their geographic location across languages. **■**